

Wipro Little Genius

The crown prince

The Wipro Little Genius has a great grey silver body; subtle use of chrome for the Scroll button and the lid lining add a touch of style. The translucent buttons are etched with white inscriptions that are easy to read in poor light. All the keys fall within easy reach. The touchpad is placed towards the left and is difficult to reach at times, especially if you use the keys at the extreme right. The battery and the swappable optical drive can be easily removed. Overall, the build-quality is top notch, but the attention to detail is nowhere near the IBM laptop.

Equipped with a 1.4 GHz Pentium M processor and 256 MB of DDR RAM, the 20 GB hard disk is too less and one should consider the optional 40 GB hard drive. Windows XP Home Edition and Norton AntiVirus are bundled along. The DVD-ROM is a standard accessory, while the combo drive is optional. The infra-red port is placed at an uncomfortable extreme right side corner. All other connectors—USB ports, LAN, etc—are conveniently placed for uninterrupted use. The neon blue LEDs for system status indicators give the laptop a

pleasing appeal. The Audio DJ lets you use the optical drive as a CD player without switching on the entire system. Memory card readers allow SD and MMC cards to be read directly. Unfortunately, the Little Genius heats up to a sweaty 42 degrees.

It displayed good performance and came in very close to the IBM T40 in most of the tests. The overall system benchmark that used ZDbench Business Winstone just saw a marginal difference between the two. The T40's graphics card vanquished the humble Intel 855 onboard display on the Wipro laptop. However, it beat the IBM in the battery life test, lasting over 4 hours—the highest in the comparison. Its carry case was the best amongst the lot, with a lot of storage space.

At Rs 80,000, this laptop packs a punch; buy it if you can't afford the IBM T40.

Price: Rs 91,990
+ Elegant design
- Low on features

Wipro Little Genius

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶

outlined silver-black body. The layout of the keys, though well-spanned, leaves enough space for your palm to rest. The optical drive and two USB ports are placed on the right side for easy access, whereas a Type-II Compact Flash slot and connectors for an external monitor, LAN and modem are placed to the left. It has 4 USB ports and a single PS/2 port. No serial or parallel port is provided. The only flaw was its thermodynamics. Its temperature soared to 42 degrees Celsius even before the test could conclude.

Though equipped with just a low-powered 1.3 GHz processor, the laptop turned in a decent performance, with scores pretty much in the same league as that of the IBM T40 and Acer TravelMate 290.

The bottleneck was the hard disk, which was quite evident from the SiSoft Sandra's hard disk scores that were the lowest amongst its brethren. The batteries went dead after 3 hours of continuous usage. Zenith does not bundle any OS with the laptop and leaves it as a customisable option.

Priced at Rs 70,000, the Zenith ONE-UP Notebook (Wi-Fi 4X) a must buy for those on a shoestring budget. Be prepared for a hot lap though!

Zenith ONE-UP Notebook (WiFi 4x)

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 70,000
+ Great value for money
- Heats up

Zenith ONE-UP Notebook (Wi-Fi 4X)

Centrino for masses

The Zenith ONE-UP notebook comes with a Pentium M 1.3 GHz, 256 MB of DDR RAM, a 30 GB hard disk and a combo-drive. For the first time ever, Zenith adopted a sober, subtle styling, resulting in a good-looking notebook with silver shades amidst a black background. The keyboard is another touch of style with grey keys looking fantastic on the

